

Figure 12: Settings menu

Setting it up

The first thing to do is check out what all you can configure—that's right, tap **Settings** (under the app menu). See Figure 12. Different things you can configure in the device are placed here under relevant categories like:

- **Personalisation** – It lets you set the themes, phone profiles (like ring tones, silent mode, vibrations, etc), region, date display, notification light, text input, etc.
- **Connectivity** – This has things like Internet connections (let's you choose and set preferences between WLAN, GPRS, 3G, etc), online sharing accounts (OVI, Facebook and Flickr), Bluetooth, GPS settings, phone settings, VOIP/IM accounts (besides OVI, you have, Skype, AIM, Google Talk, Yahoo!, MSN, etc), Bluetooth, etc. Heck, you even have an FM transmitter here :-)
- **General** – This one lists memory (storage space consumption and availability), TV out, screen calibration, device lock settings and *About product*. [With the help of this last option I was able to figure out that this N900 didn't have the latest Maemo 5 update.] Things I took care of here at

one go were, setting up the WLAN connection, IM accounts and text input. This last option lets you enable a virtual keyboard also (disabled by default), thus making you, sort of, independent of the physical QWERTY keyboard. Although I love the physical keyboard, my wife seemed to prefer the virtual one—God knows why she liked using it with the stylus, or

Full-blown Web browsing

Well, once the WLAN's up, what else can an Internet addict do besides opening the Web browser? This one comes with a Mozilla-powered browser (called MicroB) and it's damn exciting to use—thanks to the default landscape layout and the keyboard.

Tap **Web** from the app menu, and you open the browser. At the bottom is the address bar and the top portion has your bookmarks with a thumbnail view of the page (Figure 13). Enter an address and hit the return key—it opens the website in a new window, leaving this home window in the background.

Seriously, it feels just like I'm using a regular full-blown browser—no need to go back to things like Opera Mini. Most websites open in their default layout (not mobile), and because of the larger screen resolution, and the landscape mode, you needn't horizontally scroll to read, say, Wikipedia entries (Figure 14). Once a website loads up, the browser automatically switches to the full-screen mode to give you that full 800x480 px resolution for your reading pleasure. You get a small icon on the right-bottom portion of the screen to go back to the windowed mode.

For a quick and casual zoom in, simply double tap on the Web page—another double tap reverts to the original size. If you need finer

control over zoom, use the hardware volume controller. And thanks to the availability of Adobe Flash plug-in, YouTube and other Flash videos play the way they're supposed to, inside the browser and not on some separate app. See Figure 15.

A brilliant feature is the ability to bring in the mouse cursor through a simple gesture. Swipe your finger fast (or the stylus) from outside the left-side of the screen towards right (that is, into the screen), and you get a small mouse icon. Tap it and you get the cursor. Now simply drag the cursor on text to select it (Figure 16), and hit Ctrl+c to copy—yes, you can paste it anywhere using Ctrl+p.

Another nice feature is when you press your finger gently on the screen, a pop-up menu appears with the options to open a new window, add the Web page URL (as a bookmark or a desktop shortcut) or "save page as" to save it somewhere in your filesystem.

When in the windowed mode, tapping the title bar will give you another menu. Some of the options are a repeat from the tap gesture menu, but you also have things like reload the page, search on page, FF download manager, Web page details, and browser preferences (that is, *Options*). From *Options*, you can configure the browser settings, or access Add-ons—yes, it opens the Firefox extensions manager :-)

Another nice feature is the recent

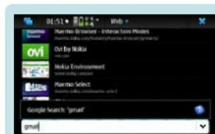


Figure 13: Browser's home screen



Figure 14: Browsing Wikipedia



Figure 15: Watching a YouTube video



Figure 16: Selecting text